WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

TANZANIA

Africa

Information current as of November 2026

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Dar es Salaam	Commercial capital and East Africa's leading gateway port, which handled a record 33.7 million tonnes in 2025/26 with DP World as an operator	Port logistics, financial services, manufacturing, real estate
Dodoma	Political capital and seat of government, linked to Dar es Salaam by the electric Standard Gauge Railway (SGR), where demand has prompted extra services	Administration, construction, rail-linked logistics
Lindi and Mtwara (south)	Base for the planned $42 billion Tanzania LNG project led by Equinor and Shell, targeting 47.13 trillion cubic feet of gas; also the heart of cashew production	Natural gas and LNG, oilfield services, agro-processing
Tanga	Northern port and terminus of the 1,443 km East African Crude Oil Pipeline (EACOP) from Uganda, more than 90% complete with first exports expected in early 2027	Oil export logistics, port services, industry
Lake Victoria gold belt (Geita, Mwanza, Shinyanga)	Centre of a gold sector whose exports reached $5.67 billion in the year to July 2026, up 37.4%	Gold mining, mining services, refining, lake-zone trade
Arusha and the northern circuit	Hub for safari tourism and home to the East African Community headquarters; tourism receipts reached $4.29 billion in the year to July 2026	Tourism and hospitality, horticulture, regional services
Zanzibar	Semi-autonomous archipelago within the United Republic with its own investment authority; growth of 6.7% in Q1 2026 driven by tourism	Tourism, blue economy, real estate

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Tanzania Investment and Special Economic Zones Authority (TISEZA), launched on 1 July 2025 under the Tanzania Investment and Special Economic Zones Act 2025, merging the Tanzania Investment Centre and the Export Processing Zones Authority into a single digital one-stop facilitation centre
- Certificate of Incentives and strategic investor status under the investment regulations, with a minimum initial capital of $500,000 for foreign-owned projects and joint ventures and relief on import duty for capital goods

- Special Economic Zones and Export Processing Zones, now administered by TISEZA, offering tax and customs incentives for qualifying export-oriented and industrial projects
- Bank of Tanzania oversight of a flexible shilling; profits, dividends and capital can be transferred through authorised dealer banks, while rules issued in March 2025 require domestic transactions to be settled in shillings
- Sector-entry routes through production-sharing arrangements with the Tanzania Petroleum Development Corporation (TPDC) for oil and gas, and licensing under the Ministry of Minerals for mining
- Public-private partnerships under the PPP framework, amended in 2023 to allow international arbitration for PPP projects in transport, energy and social infrastructure
- Zanzibar Investment Promotion Authority (ZIPA) as the separate entry point for investment in Zanzibar's tourism, blue-economy and property sectors

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Tanzania in October 2026 is one of Africa's most consistent growth stories, now underpinned by major new infrastructure. Real GDP grew 5.9% in 2025, up from 5.6% in 2024, lifting the economy to $91.8 billion on the rebased 2019 series, with financial services (+15.7%), electricity and gas (+11.8%) and mining (+9.4%) leading. Growth held at around 6% in the first half of 2026 and the government targets 6.3% for the year. Inflation was 4.3% in September, within the 3–5% target, and the Bank of Tanzania held its policy rate at 6.25% for Q4. Exports of goods and services rose 16.5% to $20 billion in the year to July 2026, led by gold ($5.67 billion) and tourism ($4.29 billion). FDI inflows rose 28.3% to $1.72 billion in 2024, and TISEZA registered a record 915 projects worth $10.95 billion in 2025. The 2,115 MW Julius Nyerere Hydropower Plant, inaugurated in August 2026, and a record year at Dar es Salaam port strengthen the platform for industry and regional trade.

Tanzania's main structural challenge in 2026 is rebuilding confidence after the October 2025 election period, when unrest was met with a heavy security response; a government commission recorded at least 518 deaths, and Western governments and NGOs have called for accountability. Economic activity reopened within weeks, and the macroeconomic framework has stayed on track: Tanzania reached staff-level agreement on the final reviews of its IMF programme in May 2026, domestic revenue rose to 16.8% of GDP in 2025/26, and reserves of more than $6 billion cover 4.3 months of imports. The Middle East conflict has added a second test through higher fuel prices, which the central bank has met with a timely rate rise while high gold prices keep the current account deficit near 2.5% of GDP. For investors, the opportunity lies in a large, fast-growing market whose energy, logistics and resource projects are moving towards delivery, approached with careful governance and reputational due diligence.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Post-election political climate	The October 2025 election period saw deadly unrest and an internet shutdown, and further protests and protest concerns have periodically affected trading in 2026	Build business-continuity and staff-safety planning, conduct human-rights and reputational due diligence, and engage through established business bodies; growth has remained near 6% throughout
Imported fuel costs and the Middle East conflict	Fuel prices have risen 40–50% since the conflict began and net oil imports equal 3.3% of GDP, lifting inflation to 4.3%	The Bank of Tanzania raised its rate to 6.25% to anchor prices; record gold earnings and new hydropower capacity reduce exposure and favour energy-efficiency and renewables investment
Foreign-currency liquidity and the shilling	Periodic dollar shortages have caused payment delays in some sectors, and March 2025 rules require domestic transactions in shillings	Agree currency and payment terms early with authorised dealer banks and hedge where needed; reserves of more than $6 billion and rising exports support the shilling
Governance and regulatory predictability	Institutional quality scores remain modest, and past changes to agreed fiscal terms have slowed some large projects	Use TISEZA's one-stop centre and Certificate of Incentives, seek strategic investor status, and include international arbitration in project agreements where available

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Large-project timelines	LNG negotiations paused in 2023 and EACOP first exports have moved to early 2027, although LNG terms were described as largely complete in September 2026	Position early for supply-chain, services and local-content contracts as both projects approach delivery
Public debt and fiscal space	Public debt is projected at about 49% of GDP in 2026, below the regional average, with external debt just under 40% of GDP	Completion of the IMF programme, rising domestic revenue and a deficit target below 3% of GDP support sustainability; PPPs offer routes into infrastructure
Inland logistics capacity	Port volumes are growing faster than inland roads and handling capacity, with about 3,100 heavy trucks leaving Dar es Salaam port each day	The SGR, a new oil storage facility and the Kurasini Logistics Park are adding capacity and creating openings in warehousing, haulage and rail services

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Tanzania's risk profile combines strong and steady macroeconomic fundamentals with a political environment that requires closer attention than before 2025. Growth of around 6%, inflation within target, a current account deficit below 3% of GDP, completion of the IMF programme and moderate public debt of about 49% of GDP give the economy genuine resilience, and record gold and tourism earnings have cushioned the 2026 oil-price shock. The events surrounding the October 2025 election have led some risk assessors to revise their view of political stability, and Western governments have criticised the handling of the unrest; there are no international sanctions restricting investment, but investors should treat human-rights, reputational and ESG due diligence as a core part of entry. Practical mitigants include business-continuity planning, clear currency and payment terms, international arbitration provisions and structuring through TISEZA. With these in place, investors can access one of Africa's most dependable growth markets at a time when transformative energy and logistics projects are approaching delivery.

MARKET ACCESS

Tanzania is a member of both the East African Community (EAC) and the Southern African Development Community (SADC), and a participant in the African Continental Free Trade Area, giving it a unique bridge between eastern and southern African markets. It has been a WTO member since 1995. The country's main export markets are South Africa, India and the United Arab Emirates, followed by China, Kenya and regional neighbours, with gold accounting for close to half of goods export earnings. Dar es Salaam port is a gateway for landlocked neighbours across East and Central Africa, with transit cargo rising strongly and inland links now strengthened by the SGR. The completion of EACOP to Tanga, surplus power from new hydropower capacity and growing transit volumes are deepening Tanzania's role as a regional trade and energy hub.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (Samia Suluhu Hassan) and Prime Minister (Mwigulu Nchemba)	Set national economic policy and the Vision 2050 agenda, and drive flagship energy and infrastructure projects	Primary reference point for Tanzania's strategic direction and large-project priorities
Tanzania Investment and Special Economic Zones Authority (TISEZA)	National investment and SEZ authority, providing the one-stop centre, incentive certificates and aftercare	Standard first point of contact for market entry, incentives and zone access
Bank of Tanzania (Governor Emmanuel Tutuba)	Sets the Central Bank Rate, manages reserves and oversees foreign-exchange and banking rules	Relevant for currency, repatriation and banking-sector matters
President's Office, Planning and Investment (Minister Kitila Mkumbo)	Leads national development planning and investment policy, including the 2026/27 National Development Plan	Key policy counterpart for strategic projects and investment-climate dialogue
Ministry of Energy and Tanzania Petroleum Development Corporation	Lead the LNG negotiations, oversee EACOP on the Tanzanian side and manage	Essential partner for any oil, gas and power engagement

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
(TPDC)	upstream gas licensing	
Ministry of Minerals (Minister Anthony Mavunde)	Oversees the gold and critical-minerals sector, which provides close to half of goods export earnings	Central counterpart for mining licences and mineral-processing investment
Tanzania Ports Authority	Manages Dar es Salaam, Tanga and Mtwara ports and the Port Master Plan targeting 62 million tonnes a year by 2031	Relevant for logistics, port-concession and transit investment

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Tanzania Private Sector Foundation (TPSF) is the apex body for private-sector dialogue with government, alongside the Tanzania Chamber of Commerce, Industry and Agriculture (TCCIA) and the Tanzania National Business Council, which brings government and business leaders together on investment-climate reform. TISEZA runs regular investor forums and sector outreach, and in Zanzibar ZIPA plays a similar role. The World Bank, IMF, African Development Bank and IFC maintain substantial programmes in energy, transport and private-sector development, and international operators such as DP World and the LNG and EACOP partners provide valuable practical insight into large-project delivery.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Tanzania suits investors seeking long-term exposure to a large, consistently growing East African market: mining and mineral-processing investors building on record gold exports; energy investors positioned for LNG, EACOP-linked services and power trade from new hydropower capacity; logistics and infrastructure investors drawn by Dar es Salaam's record port volumes, the SGR and PPP opportunities; tourism and hospitality investors in the northern circuit and Zanzibar; and agribusiness and financial-services investors serving fast-growing domestic demand. Investors comfortable with emerging-market governance considerations and committed to strong ESG standards are best placed to benefit.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage TISEZA and secure incentive terms
Use the one-stop centre to register, obtain a Certificate of Incentives and assess eligibility for strategic investor status or SEZ benefits.

STEP 2: Conduct governance and reputational due diligence
Review the post-2025 political environment, human-rights expectations and partner integrity, and build business-continuity planning into operations.

STEP 3: Agree currency and payment arrangements early
Work with authorised dealer banks on shilling settlement, foreign-currency access and hedging so that repatriation plans are clear from the outset.

STEP 4: Position for LNG, EACOP and power opportunities
Engage TPDC, the Ministry of Energy and the project partners on supply-chain, services and local-content roles as major energy projects approach delivery.

STEP 5: Leverage corridor and regional market access
Use Dar es Salaam port, the SGR and EAC and SADC membership to serve neighbouring landlocked markets from a Tanzanian base.